Lesson Plan: Talking About Plans, Present Progressive for the Future

B2 (intermediate) | 21 adult ESL learners | Community college | 120 minutes

Objectives

By the end of this lesson, learners will be able to:

- Form the present progressive for future actions (am/is/are + verb-ing).
- Use it to talk about fixed, scheduled plans, including a clear future time expression.

Rationale

English has several ways to talk about the future (*will*, *be going to*, the present progressive), and each signals a different level of planning. For fixed arrangements the present progressive is a high-frequency, natural choice for appointments, meetings and personal plans. Keck and Kim (2014) emphasize that grammar teaching works best when learners see the link between form and communicative purpose. Intermediate learners already know the form, so the focus shifts to its future meaning and context (Folse, 2016).

Materials

- Slides, whiteboard or projector
- Weekly planner image (lead-in)
- Error Correction worksheet and answer key (separate PDF)
- Schedule Swap grid (separate PDF)

Procedure

Stage	Time	What happens
Lead-in	15 min	Display a weekly planner. Ask: *What are you doing after your first class on Tuesday? What are your fixed plans for Saturday? Who are you meeting after class on Monday? What's happening on Friday?* Write 4 to 6 answers, correct and incorrect, on the board to revisit later.
Presentation	20 min	Teach the form (S + am/is/are + verb-ing). Contrast two uses: now (*I'm eating now*) and planned future (*I'm eating at 7 tonight*). Check with present/future prompts. Teach negatives and questions, then run a choral drill (for example: *you / meet / professor / Monday?* becomes *Are you meeting your professor on Monday?*).
Activity 1: controlled written practice	30 min	Pairs correct 10 sentences with common errors: missing am/is/are, base verb instead of -ing, or missing future time marker. The teacher circulates, gives mini-explanations, and corrects as a class afterward.
Activity 2: Schedule Swap	35 min	Set a scenario: planning a busy weekend in town. Model a dialogue with a volunteer. In pairs, learners interview each other about 5 fixed plans (*What are you doing on Tuesday morning?*) and write their partner's plans on a grid, for example *He's meeting his advisor on Tuesday morning.*
Wrap-up	10 min	Review the structure and the rule about the future time marker. Revisit the lead-in sentences and decide whether the present progressive fits each plan.

Stage	Time	What happens
Homework	5 min	Write 8 to 10 sentences about your fixed plans for the weekend or next week. Use the present progressive, include at least one negative, and vary the time expressions.

Assessment

- Formative: teacher circulates during the worksheet and speaking task and gives immediate feedback.
- Homework paragraph checked for form, negatives and time expressions.

References

Folse, K. S. (2016). *Keys to teaching grammar to English language learners* (2nd ed.). University of Michigan Press.

Keck, C., & Kim, Y. (2014). Pedagogical grammar: Theoretical and experimental issues. *Revista Española de Lingüística Aplicada, 29*(2), 172-194.